

Week 9: Video Transcript

Hello everyone and welcome back. As always, this is Rebecca Lyddon, the director of education at the Jai Institute for Parenting. I'm so thankful that you have returned, I imagine that you feel as if you've been running a marathon for the last nine weeks and I commend you, I see you, and I would love to offer you the gift of imperfection. I'm reminding you that in no way at all, do I or the coach that you are working with expect you to have memorized everything that you have learned thus far in this process and to live it perfectly on a day to day basis, either within yourself or with your child or children. I'm not sure if that's humanly possible, so we are practicing being in that ventral vagal state of inner safety, connected to the prefrontal cortex, believing and rooted in expansive beliefs like, you are capable of learning new things, trusting this process, and believing that you are sinking in integrating, meaning making sense of it, understanding it, comprehending it, and thus living it at your own perfect pace. This may not be as fast as you would like it to be and impatience is a consequence of living in the middle brain, the mammalian brain, where you're stuck in that fear, scarcity, and desire for instant gratification. Who here wants your child to be more patient with you as you are preparing or doing anything throughout your day? Probably most of you. We must practice patience within ourselves too, which is a big ask for many of us and it's a practice. So my invitation for you as you settle into week nine of the peace process is to trust that you are in an ongoing practice that never ever, ever ends. How exciting! How wonderful!

We are going to move forward together into understanding the essence of empowered parenting, getting to know this five step process that we call the peace process that we believe, experience, and absolutely encourage all parents to use as a means of replacing any kind of what Marshall Rosenberg, the author and creator of Non-violent Communication, would call tragic strategies. This can be threatening, punishment, timeouts, bribes, access for words, manipulation, shaming, yelling, spanking, et cetera, any kind of power over or under strategy. We are learning the middle way here in empowered parenting, and we have spent the last nine weeks building the foundation of this five step process. So let's look back in time as usual because we need to keep coherence as Daniel Siegel, the author of *The Power of Showing Up*, *The Whole Brained Child*, *No Drama Discipline*, and *Parenting From The Inside Out*. He is always recommending for us to earn that secure attachment and develop greater safety in our neurophysiology to create a coherent narrative.



Looking back in time and weaving together what you've learned so far, being very clear on how this is integrating, meaning, how am I making sense of it? Am I comprehending it? Am I able to really live it? Or is it still sinking in? And wherever you are at in your integration process is okay. It's simply being able to name it.

In our workbook this week, we have a check-in of all of the tools and the frameworks that you have learned as an empowered parent these last nine weeks. Your relationship with each of these tools and frameworks will create your ultimate, for right now, relationship with the peace process. We're going to go step by step through the peace process together and it is a discipline response. We are wanting to get into the essence of empowered parenting and many people are wondering, "Well, no consequences, no punishments? How am I teaching my child what the right thing to do is? Or what good behavior is? Or what I expect of them?" The truth, the essence of discipline is being in that power with teacher. It's not being in a power over dynamic or a power under, it's being in a working together with the child, teaching them when the timing is appropriate, when they are safe, emotionally regulated, and connected with you. Their ears are open, their front brain is online, and they're able to receive your teachings. We are in the process of long-term parenting, raising elders, not simply raising good kids that do good things so we aren't losing our minds every day.

And I understand the longing to want to have immediate validation of your efforts. If we are rooted in a belief that we are capable, we are competent, and we trust ourselves as parents, then we're able to really parent for the long term, even if the day to day is messy, chaotic, and there is conflict sometimes. We all go through phases of transformation and growth, and we're fussy. I don't think fussy days ever end. When you have a baby and they're just fussy that day, they can't be settled. They're crying, they're grumpy, and all of the things that are happening for the baby. That never ends. They're going through a growth spurt and you go through growth spurts, I go through growth spurts, and our children go through growth spurts and they have fussy days, weeks, and even months. We're no longer rooting in fear and trying to parent through terror. That is so uncomfortable. But for many people, parenting in trust is even more uncomfortable where parenting from fear is actually familiar. So we're going to go slowly into this peace process and encourage you, if this is a brand new way of parenting -- you've been here for nine weeks so I imagine that you've been building the foundation, you understand what you have committed yourself to -- and being okay with wherever you are at in this peace process.

If you can only baby step yourself and you're still relying on consequences, threats, or punishments, and you are dedicated to weaning yourself off of those strategies and being able to use a strategy that is rooted in empathy, it is rooted in a secure attachment, it's rooted in co-regulation and relational safety, it's rooted in emotional intelligence and nonviolent communication. Take a tiny baby step. Don't expect perfection at all.

We're going through your workbook. You can go ahead and pause this audio if you'd like, or you can simply follow along as we proceed into the heart of this work today. We're going to discuss the peace process broken down step-by-step and then we're going to discuss boundaries and limits from values. A lot of our teachings have to do with the way in which we are able to understand, have clarity and confidence, and have the skill set to be able to communicate boundaries with our children. The teachings, the actual recipes of teachings that we are wanting to offer our children to internalize and become. We're going to break this down into segments by age. So the way that you navigate boundaries, limits, and the peace process with a toddler to seven year old is going to be different than the way that you navigate this with an eight, nine to thirteen year old, and a thirteen year old to an eighteen or older aged child.

So we're going to look at this in developmental stages and age stages. Let's get started. Let's go ahead and take your workbook out, and turn to the peace process. And the P in the peace process is presence. We've learned all about presence. We've learned about your ANCHOR. You can probably feel my energy slowing down and getting more rooted in this moment. I can feel it. So the peace process is a method of responding to any kind of parenting scenario, any kind of sibling conflict, any kind of infraction against our boundary or our limit, the trial of not being able to keep the agreement, or pushing those boundaries or passing those boundaries. This is our method of response. It's built on everything you've learned so far around understanding the nervous system, understanding the brain, the belief system, understanding empathy, emotions, feelings, needs, and how to communicate all of the above. So we're having a scenario happen in front of us that is requiring a response, an empowered response. It requires us to embody benevolent leadership and be the adult, the empowered adult, and our first step is presence. So before I respond to my child or to my children who are having a sibling squabble or any kind of dynamic that is challenging in the moment, I am anchoring myself in presence.

Get curious with yourself, what is your sensory calming tool? Remember, we're not trying to make your feelings go away. We're not trying to suppress your feelings by giving you a tool. We're just trying to find presence and safety.

So you get to feel whatever you're feeling, have the feeling in your body, your physiology. We're not making it wrong, we're not trying to stop it. We're wanting to find center. You can experience chaos in the body, in the mind, but this [center] is rooted. This [center] is anchored down into security and safety. So what is that for you? It's an exploration process. My go-to example is my children because I've got two of them and one is almost four and one is almost eight, as I make this recording. We live in a tiny house, we live in a 600 square foot house with a dog, a cat, two children and two adults, and it's absolutely insane. So I get to practice the peace process a thousand bazillion times a day. So when I am witnessing my children learning how to cohabitate, learning how to communicate, and learning how to be in an intimate relationship with another person, I am rooting myself in presence.

What I've been doing lately is, "I'm safe. I can handle whatever this is going to be. I am capable. I am safe. Hands on heart, feet on floor. I'm aware of my breath." This does not happen overnight. I've been practicing this for almost 10 years, so this is a practice, a practice of presence. I will remind you that 99.9% of conscious parenting happens after you mess up, you fall, you make a mistake, and you miss an opportunity for presence. You're inviting one of the pillars, which is reflection. "How could I have gained presence before responding to those children earlier today? Oh, I really missed that opportunity to gain presence before responding. I wish that I would've done it like this". So we're always reflecting and considering how we could have done it differently. That's practicing in our minds. You can go through that scenario in your mind and redo it and feel it in your body, how it would have been if you would have taken a millisecond to ground and then respond.

So the E is every emotion, emotional connection and empathy. The E in the peace process is emotions, emotional intelligence, empathy, and emotional connection. So after I have gained presence and I'm able to go into the parenting scenario, I am practicing internal, verbal empathy. I am naming my feelings and my needs. So presence is really rooting us into the right side of the brain, where we have our emotional experience, we have our connection to our body, we have all of these feelings happening in our bodies, and we're finding safety within them. Anything that's happened is coming from this area [right side] of the brain, I am safe and I'm capable of it. Then we're going into the left side of the brain, where we add language, we add a framework, we add a sequencing to. So I am naming feelings and needs. Let's say my body is tight, my body is angry, I'm feeling annoyed, I'm really longing for peace, I'm feeling frustrated, I'm longing for ease, and I'm feeling tired. I'm really longing for rest and relaxation. That might not happen so easily and quickly for you in the beginning, because this is a practice. I don't expect Mozart when you're just learning how to play Mary had a little lamb on the piano.



Maybe all you're able to say in that moment is "angry". You're a caveman, and that's all you can access in that moment, and that's okay. "Me angry!" And you're going into the room because we know that when we establish ANCHOR and safety, we're regulating the nervous system. When we give a name to our emotions and our feelings, we're regulating the brain and the nervous system. We're going to be able to be present and we won't be operating from the amygdala, the limbic system, and fight or flight, which is going to make everything so much harder and it is going to make power over strategies or power under strategies irresistible, and potentially the only strategies that will work in that moment.

Our safety is our children's safety. Our children's behaviors come from an instinctual response of danger. So if we're barreling into the room saying, "What's going on in here? I've told you that I'm working." If we're barreling into the room like that, our children are going to respond in the mirror. They're going to respond with the same thing or it's the opposite. They're going to meet us in that aggression, they're going to meet us in that intimidation, or they're going to shut down and they're going to become frozen and numb. It's very hard to solve conflict, have teaching moments, or impart conscious discipline when someone is trying to attack you or is falling down and playing dead. So I'm going into the room ANCHORED to the best of my ability, imperfectly, at least it's in my consciousness. If all I can say is, "I wish that I was present right now, but I'm not. If I enter the room and I say, "Angry, feel it here". We're slowing down to support the children.

So some of you may be in the conditioning of wanting to fix your child's problems, wanting to get down to the nitty gritty and the logistics, and try to understand it. "What is going on here? What are you doing? Give me the answers! Why? Answer me!" We're wanting answers, we're wanting names, and we're wanting in the left brain. We want to take care of it right now, we want immediate resolution. What we're wanting to slow down and do is connect with the right side of our child's brain, understanding their feelings, and what's going on for them. "Are you safe? Is anybody hurt? How are you?", and then going into the more teaching and left brain way of understanding the conflict.

So moving from the E, emotional intelligence, emotional connection, moving from your right brain into your child's right brain, being a safe space so your child can borrow your safety. We're going into the A, which is to acknowledge what is true. This is us being able to accept what is right here before us, so we're practicing, being able to see "what is" with a neutral observation, rather than an emotional interpretation. Instead of coming in the room and saying, "I never get to have any time alone and you are always interrupting me.

You don't ever play by yourself, and every time I leave the room, you're getting into something!" etc etc. We're emotionally reactive and we're seeing through the lens of scarcity and fear. So we're practicing that sports casting. I've come into the room, I see that one child's crying, I see that the other child is holding a broken airplane, and I am so curious about what is happening here. So it's being able to shift into the mindset of curiosity and accepting that you are needed right now. You're a parent, you have children, and they need you a lot of the time. They are dependent on you for problem-solving regulation, making sense of their experience, and how to navigate difficulty and disconnection in a conscious, empowered way. Our voice becomes their inner voice. The more emotionally objective we can be and what we are witnessing, and the more we can accept and surrender to what is in the moment, the easier it will be for us, our children, and our relationship long-term.

I understand how difficult it can be to really accept what is, and to allow it to happen, especially if you were caught off guard or you're trying to focus on another child or dinner or whatever it is you're doing, perhaps you're distracted, the best that you can do is eliminate distractions. Put the phone down, turn the burner off on the stove and show up with your child or your children with a sense of presence and safety, with an emotional connection and relational safety, and accepting what is without any judgment, without fear stories, without emotional elaboration, and drama.

So we're going into the C now of the peace process, which is conscious communication, compassionate communication, and we're going to work this out more elaborately in the workbook, and you had a whole week last week on the empowered conversation. Being able to speak in "I" statements, being able to name what you're experiencing, what you're feeling, what you're longing for, how to navigate your inner experience consciously through your words that are not harmful, that are not shameful, threatening, or causing any kind of disruption between you and your child. There's some great questions to ask here like, "Help me understand." We're not making assumptions, we're not going into the room and having the whole story played out in our head. We're coming in and asking, "I'm really struggling to understand what this conflict is about. How about you, Oniya?", that's my daughter's name. "Oniya, would you be willing to share with me please what's happening here? And Heron, I'm going to hold you sweetie while Oniya shares her side of the story, and then it will be your turn to speak. Is everyone willing to make that agreement of one person speaking at a time? Okay. And I'll be here to help you with that." My daughter will share her experience and I'll say, "Thank you for sharing that, and Heron, how about you, honey? What's your story? And he's three so he talks a lot, and I'm like, "Okay, yes, yes, yes. Something about a dinosaur, an airplane, and a fossil, okay".



Oniya has learned that in our home one person is speaking at a time and we're giving them our undivided attention, so if she forgets and she begins to interrupt, I'll say, "Ah, ah in our home, one person is speaking at a time and she remembers the boundary and I'm doing it with kindness, compassion, and safety. And then I'm holding an ANCHORed, empowered, and expansive belief that we're going to figure this out together. In our home, we problem solve. That's what we do, and we are a team and everyone matters. Everyone's story matters, feelings, needs, and we're going to get through this. Now my children are so familiar with this process that my daughter is able to say, "Let's get curious!" Or "Let's get creative!"

That leads us into the E of the peace process, which is exploring solutions together. This is where our boundaries, our negotiation, our ability to make clear requests really comes in and it will depend upon the age of your child. So if you're navigating this with children who are under seven, between seven and 13, and over 13, it's going to look a little bit differently. Both of my children are in the under seven age range, and so I'm able to navigate this a bit more smoothly with congruence to their age group. It's going to be our ability to understand the goal as a family. So this is going to be you having clarity about what your family values are and being able to teach your family values by your ability to communicate the boundary and the limit that upholds, regards, respects, and protects that family value.

So if our solution and our problem solving and exploring creatively together is something like, "In our home children, we really value teamwork as one of our family values, right? Yeah, it is! It's something that we hold so dear. So I'm so curious, how could we make sure that we're doing our very best to honor our value of teamwork? And Oniya gets to -- and this is just a common example -- watch the show that she wants to watch and Heron gets to watch the show that he wants to watch. I wonder how we're going to figure this out". So under the age of seven, I am allowing my children to participate in this negotiation problem solving process with parameters. So I'm giving them two-ish options and let's start there and see if that would work. "So I'm wondering Oniya if you'd be willing to watch one of Heron's shows and then you could both watch one of Oniya's shows. How does that sound?" "No, no, I don't want to do that. I don't want to watch Oniya's shows or I don't want to watch Heron's shows". Well, okay. That one didn't work. So let's try again, "I'm so curious. How about Oniya, you go in your room on the iPad and Heron you go in the living room on the TV." I'm recording this during a pandemic, so don't judge me. And they're like, "Yeah, that works!" And I'd say, "Yay woohoo! We did it, we solved the problem! And we get to do our, we solve the problem dance and it's a celebration. My children feel empowered.



They feel heard. They feel seen. I feel excited because I'm proud of myself. I was able to show up with integrity. I was able to follow the five steps of the peace process, it just flowed and I'm really happy, and then I get to go back to the kitchen and finish cooking dinner.

So it doesn't always go so smoothly, does it? Sometimes it takes a lot more time. When we go into fear and scarcity, we start to believe "I don't have all the time in the world. I can't just sit around problem-solving with my child all day, Rebecca!" And I say, well just try, just try it anyway. See what happens. Of course, you're not going to sit around and problem solve with your child all day. That's actually thoughts that are coming from fear and scarcity in your brain, a lack of emotional objectivity, and exaggerating your reality. So we're just going to start with a baby step of one time a day. Can you prioritize communal problem solving while having an understanding of your role in the boundary and negotiation process depending on age? So I have other examples of age groups in the workbook, you can take a look at those. And of course, your fabulous coach will be here with you every step of the way, helping you find boundaries, limits, and exploring solutions together with your child or children that make sense for you.

Let's unpack boundaries a little bit more, okay? Because this is a ginormous topic. It's super-duper on fire right now, and people are trying to understand it. So what we believe boundaries are, are the structure of the home, the family that we are creating, the system. It is the walls. It is the roof. It's the piping. It's everything that makes it all work. So we have the foundation of safety and security. We have the foundation of emotional attunement, conscious communication, brain science, and awareness. Now we're learning how to make the thing happen and bring it to life. Our boundaries are fueled by our values. So if you were to imagine the trunk of a tree -- I love my analogies, if you can't tell -- we have a trunk of the tree, which is the value. Let's say for me, it's teamwork, that example I just gave for you. Our family value is teamwork, and then from the trunk of the tree come many branches. The branches are the boundaries. The boundaries could be, we don't turn off somebody's show while they're watching it. Or another boundary could be when we do the dishes, one person cleans and one person dries. Or another boundary could be, not only one person takes the trash out every day, we rotate. Boundaries are our strategies to honor our values. They give our children a sense of parameter, structure, predictability, and consistency. They understand what is expected of them. We gotta be really careful here because the power over parenting paradigm expects children to be able to follow boundaries, family rules, limits, and keep agreements perfectly, way before they're capable of doing that, which is actually never because I don't think anybody's ever perfect at following boundaries, honoring limits, or keeping agreements in their life. I think that's very human.



So we have to be very aware that we are dedicated to the process and the engagement with the boundary, the limit, and the agreement, not necessarily perfectly accomplishing the boundary limits or agreement.

If you have a narrative in your mind like, "My child doesn't listen to the rules, or they're defiant, or they're always crossing our boundaries. They don't respect our boundaries, they don't respect our rules. We need to be very, very, very curious here and use the root to bloom process. What is happening for the child that is creating a sense of lacking success and being able to adhere, follow, respect, or deliver upon the expectations placed upon them. Are the expectations age appropriate? Are they appropriate based on the security of your attachment? Because we know that if a child is not safe and secure with their parent, they don't trust their parent and they're not going to trust the boundaries. They're not going to trust the rules and they're not going to follow the limits because they're terrified inside of their bodies. So before we're focusing on a child being able to follow the rules, follow the directions, keep the agreement, adhere to the family boundary, we're going, of course, underneath to the connection. And a lot of our boundaries has to do with our communication.

Being able to communicate our boundaries, our rules, and our agreement in a way where everyone feels like they matter. They believe they matter. They're seen, they're heard, they're involved in the process, and it makes sense to them. So many of our boundaries are lacking understanding for our child or children. They don't understand why. And many of us were raised in that "Because I said, so that's why, because I'm the parent and you're the child. No more". There was no communication. There was a lack of understanding about why. "Oh, I'm just supposed to do this because you're the parent. You're the bigger, stronger person who could harm me if I don't follow your directions". So a lot of our following boundaries, limits, and agreements came from fear, scarcity, shame, coercion, and manipulation. So of course we struggle being able to have a power and dynamic with our children that is rooted in security, safety, clarity, and confidence.

We're giving you a beautiful opportunity today to get to know more about your family boundaries, where they come from, and why they exist. So our boundaries come from our core values and we're wanting to be able to be in power with, so our boundaries are not a lasso around us holding us in rigidity. We're wanting to understand when can we be flexible in our boundary or when do we need to stand firm? For me in my home, I stand when there is physical, emotional, mental, and psychological danger, imminent danger. So of course, "No, we don't run into the street. I'm not going to negotiate about that with you.

Maybe when we get home before bed, we can lay down together and talk about all of the possible scenarios. Like, well, I could run in the street if I was invisible in a car, if they hit me, I wouldn't feel it because I don't have any bones. Well then yeah, that's awesome. We can think of all kinds of creative ideas and problem solving solutions based in fantasy and illusion, dear wonderful child of mine. Let's go ahead and do that. But in the moment when we're on a busy street, I'm not going to negotiate with you. No, because I love you and my job is to keep you safe. I will not let you get hurt. I am your mama".

The more we practice being able to be rooted in security and not going into over-exaggeration, fear, or coercion, the more children will trust us. They will see our words, hear our words, view our body language, and know that they can rest in the boundary. Mama, Papa, grandparent, whoever you are, parent, you've got the kid and they trust you. So this was just the very beginning, the tip of the iceberg around boundaries, and I'm excited for you to get into this content here and work through the workbook, get to know the peace process, and play around with how you can involve the peace process with you on a daily basis in your parenting. How can you respond to any kind of teaching, any kind of conflict with your child or children? Be rooted in presence, emotional connection, acceptance, and awareness of what is right in front of you, and practice the ability to communicate your way through conflict or confusion, disconnection, and how to repair, problem solve, and move forward into your day into your life. It's quite a fun practice and it's a lovely challenge that has layers upon layers.

So for the rest of your life, you'll get to practice this. How lucky are you? And you'll have the opportunity to get clear on the values beneath your boundaries, and get curious about whether or not your boundaries are rooted in rigidity and whether or not they are rooted in clarity, security, and the ability to be flexible because you feel safe in your body. Your coach will be able to support you to navigate and differentiate this topic, so if you feel very confused about boundaries and you want to come to your coach and say, "I really struggle with screen time boundaries or curfew for my child, or bedtime", this is the nitty gritty of parenting and it's hard. Many of us aren't sure what the right thing to do is how to figure out how to make decisions, and your coach is going to be here for you. So I'm so thankful that you're here. You've made this decision, this ongoing commitment. Again, I commend you for your efforts and permission, permission, permission to mess up, to be imperfect, and then to get up and try it all over again, it's a muscle. I'll see you all next week as we discuss the topic, anger and healthy expression, healthy aggression, and until then, be safe, be well, and blessings to you all. Take care.